

EXTRACT FROM THE JOURNAL OF PROCEEDINGS OF THE 48TH REGULAR SESSION
OF THE 21ST CITY COUNCIL OF CAGAYAN DE ORO CITY ON
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COUNCILOR EDGAR S. CABANLAS: (*Majority Floor Leader*) – With that, we will proceed to special report.

We have one member of the City Council who would like to make special report, Councilor Roger G. Abaday.

May I request, Madam Chair, that Councilor Abaday be recognized.

VICE MAYOR JOCELYN B. RODRIGUEZ: (*Presiding Officer*) – Councilor Roger Abaday, you have the floor.

COUNCILOR ROGER G. ABADAY: - Thank you very much, Majority Floor Leader. Honorable Presiding Officer, fellow members of this Council, Honorable Presiding Officer, Vice Mayor Jocelyn Rodriguz, distinguished colleagues of the 21st City Council, members of the tri-media, those watching via livestream, and guests in the gallery, and also to our drag queens, good afternoon.

As chairman of the Committee on Public Order and Public Safety, I call for stronger barangay preparedness and emergency response following recent fire incidents, including the high intensity blaze in Barangay 7.

These incidents remind us that in an emergency, every second matters. A delayed response, unavailable equipment, blocked access road, or breakdown in communication can turn a fire into a tragedy.

I therefore, recommend three immediate priorities: First, strengthen operational accountability. Barangays must maintain a clear 24/7 duty system for personnel, tanods, and emergency vehicle drivers. Once a fire is confirmed, trained personnel must be able to immediately mobilize available resources without unnecessary delays. If you look at the PowerPoint presentation, that is the situation.

Where feasible, emergency vehicles should also have GPS tracking and reliable communication systems for coordination with the barangay command center and the Bureau of Fire Protection. *Ang nahitabo ang ilang* firetruck supposed to be the first responder, *pero mao na hinoon ang gi-rescue kay naabutan na sa kalayo*. The firetruck on the middle of the road.

Second, protect and maintain emergency assets. Fire trucks, rescue vehicles, pumps, hoses, extinguishers, radios, and other equipment must be properly maintained, accessible, and strategically positioned. *Ang nahitabo, wala na plastar ang ilang mga equipo. Walay personnel naka-responde. Mao kang ang resulta*